

## Word Questions at Exam Speed

Name: \_\_\_\_\_ Class: \_\_\_\_\_ Date: \_\_\_\_\_

Answer in your book. These are quick 1-mark questions on the real paper: aim for under a minute each.

|                                                                                                  |                                                                                                |                                                                                                                           |
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| <b>Swap test</b><br>Put your word in its place. The meaning AND the strength must stay the same. | <b>Point test</b><br>For “it”, “this”, “they”: put your finger on the exact words it replaces. | <b>Error codes</b><br>S = wrong strength. L = took it literally. N = grabbed the nearest noun. P = only part of the list. |
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### Part A: Do Now (4 min)

**A1** *The doorbell rang. Nobody moved.*

Why might a writer use two short sentences here?

**A2** Answer: “The writer uses a short sentence to create suspense.”

Why would this only get 1 mark out of 2?

### Part B: Find the Imposter (teams, 30 seconds a round)

Three of the four words could replace the bold word. One is an imposter: it changes the meaning or the strength. Find it fast. Bonus point if you can say WHY.

|                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                           |
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| <b>1</b> The crowd <b>roared</b> when the goal went in.<br>cheered • yelled • whispered • bellowed | <b>4</b> After the cleaners left, the room was <b>immaculate</b> .<br>spotless • perfectly clean • fairly tidy • flawless |
| <b>2</b> She <b>glanced</b> at the clock.<br>peeked • looked quickly • stared • flicked her eyes   | <b>5</b> The manager’s reply was <b>frosty</b> .<br>cold • unfriendly • icy • freezing                                    |
| <b>3</b> He was <b>reluctant</b> to leave the party.<br>unwilling • hesitant • eager • not keen    | <b>6</b> The news <b>devastated</b> the whole town.<br>crushed • shattered • upset • destroyed                            |

### Part C: Two timed bursts (alone)

**Burst 1: 4 minutes.** Which word or phrase could replace the word in bold? C5 is worth 2.

|                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                       |
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| <b>C1</b> The path was <b>treacherous</b> after the rain.<br><b>C2</b> Tom gave a <b>feeble</b> excuse and looked at the floor. | <b>C3</b> Once the visitors left, the library was <b>tranquil</b> .<br><b>C4</b> She was <b>adamant</b> that she had locked the door. |
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**C5** The old house **loomed** over the village. Give a replacement word, AND say what “loomed” adds that yours doesn’t. [2]

**Burst 2: 4 minutes.** Write the exact words each bold reference word points back to.

**C6** The coach praised the defence, the goalkeeper and the fans. **They** had never been so loud.

**C7** Sara lent Mia her jacket, but **it** was far too small for her.

**C8** Plastic bags, straws and cups will be banned from June. **This** is expected to cut litter by half.

**C9** The village voted to keep the old bridge rather than build a new road. Few regretted **it**.

### Part D: Mark it and code it (12 min)

Mark C1 to C9 as your teacher reads the answers. Next to every wrong one, write its error code (S, L, N or P). Which code did you get most?

### Part E: Exit Ticket (on your own, 2 marks)

**E** After the storm, the beach was desolate: no towels, no voices, just gulls and wet sand. It made her want to go home.

(a) Give a word that could replace “desolate”. [1] (b) What does “It” refer to? [1]